CCIR · COMPUTE CREDIT INDEX RESEARCH

Data Source Quality Policy

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Methodology	v1.0.0 (March 2026)
IOSCO Basis	Principle 14 (Not Applicable) — Data Source Quality Policy as functional replacement
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This document establishes CCIR's policy for selecting, evaluating, monitoring, and removing data sources contributing to the Compute Rate Index (CRI) family of GPU compute reference rates. It is published as the functional replacement for IOSCO Principle 14 (Submitter Code of Conduct), which is Not Applicable to CCIR because all data is collected algorithmically from public APIs and published rate cards without human submitter involvement. It also provides the documented governance framework that makes WARN-not-FAIL decisions in CCIR's automated monitoring controls auditably defensible.

1. IOSCO Principle 14 — Not Applicable

IOSCO Principle 14 (Submitter Code of Conduct) governs the conduct of entities that submit input data for benchmark determination. ESMA's BMR Q&A (Q4.6) confirms that Principle 14 does not apply to data sources that simply publish pricing publicly, which is later used to construct a benchmark. CCIR's data sources — RunPod, Shadeform, Lambda Labs, TensorDock, Nebius AI Cloud, Verda, and Vast.ai — publish their pricing publicly and are not "contributors" under BMR Article 3(1)(8).

The Reserve Bank of Australia's Cash Rate and the ECB's €STR explicitly mark Principle 14 as Not Applicable on the same basis. CCIR adopts the same position and maintains this Data Source Quality Policy as the functional replacement: documenting the criteria for source selection, ongoing monitoring standards, and procedures for adding or removing sources. This policy is the governance artifact that makes the Not Applicable designation defensible to rating agencies and structured finance counsel.

2. Active Source Universe

CCIR currently collects from nine data sources across spot and cluster index families. All sources are publicly accessible; no source communicates pricing to CCIR through any channel other than its public API or published rate card. No source is consulted, informed, or given advance notice of published index values.

Source ID	Provider	Type	CRI Models	Primary Silver Filter	Dedup Rule

RUNPOD	RunPod	Spot	H100, A100, H200, L40S, B200	*secure_cloud = True*	*None required*
SHADEFORM	Shadeform	Spot	H100, A100, H200, L40S, B200	*available = True*	*Provider dedup per snapshot*
LAMBDA	Lambda Labs	Spot	H100, B200	*capacity_available = True*	*None required*
TENSORDOCK	TensorDock	Spot	H100, A100, L40S	*tier >= 3 (datacenter-grade)*	*None required*
NEBIUS	Nebius AI Cloud	Spot	H100, H200, L40S, B200	*On-demand and preemptible rate cards*	*CPU variant dedup (L40S)*
VERDA	Verda (formerly DataCrunch)	Spot	H100, H200, A100, L40S, B200	*On-demand and spot rate cards (public REST API, no key required)*	*Block-size dedup*
VAST	Vast.ai	Spot	Interruptible pool only	*gpu_frac >= 1.0, reliability2 >= 0.90*	*machine_id dedup*
RUNPOD_CLUSTER	RunPod	Cluster	H100, A100, B200 (CLS-MM)	*Cluster price endpoint*	*None required*
LAMBDA_CLUSTER	Lambda Labs	Cluster	H100, A100, B200 (CLS-MM)	*8-GPU cluster listings*	*None required*
COREWEAVE	CoreWeave	Cluster	H100, H200, B200 (CLS-ENT)	*Published on-demand rate card*	*None required*

Vast.ai contributes to the interruptible price pool only (seller_ask_interruptible). Vast.ai is excluded from the noninterruptible index because its marketplace structure does not support a reliable noninterruptible price signal at scale. This exclusion is documented in the Methodology (§2.2) and reflected in SOURCE_EXPECTED in gold_spot_rates.

3. Source Eligibility Criteria

A data source must satisfy all of the following criteria to be eligible for inclusion in the CRI index universe. These criteria apply at initial evaluation and are reassessed semi-annually by the Oversight Committee.

Criterion	Requirement	Rationale
Hardware scope	Must offer NVIDIA datacenter GPUs (H100, H200, A100, L40S, B200, or future CRI-eligible models)	*CRI indices are GPU-model specific; general compute or consumer GPU providers are out of scope*

Pricing API	Must expose pricing via a publicly accessible API or published rate card without authentication barriers	*Automated collection is the architectural prerequisite for IOSCO P14 Not Applicable status; human-submitted prices are disqualifying*
Operational history	Must have been publicly operational for at least 90 days before shadow period begins	*New providers have elevated operational risk; 90 days establishes minimum track record for API reliability assessment*
Listing depth	Must maintain at least 10 active GPU listings at the time of evaluation	*Thin providers contribute insufficient price diversity; single-listing providers are functionally rate cards, not markets*
Datacenter grade	Hardware must be hosted in datacenter facilities (not consumer/prosumer colocation)	*CRI indices represent institutional-grade compute collateral; consumer-grade hardware is not a comparable asset class*
Price independence	Provider must set prices independently; aggregators that resell other providers' inventory without independent pricing are excluded	*Aggregator inclusion would double-count the underlying provider's price decision, violating the One Signal Per Decision-Maker principle*
No CCIR affiliation	Provider must have no equity, revenue, or referral relationship with CCIR	*Structural independence requirement; affiliated sources create conflicts that disqualify citation-grade benchmarks*

4. Shadow Period and Integration Process

New sources enter a shadow period before contributing to published indices. During shadow, data is collected and assessed in parallel but does not affect index values. The shadow period validates API reliability, data quality, and pricing pattern consistency against the existing source universe before Oversight Committee approval is sought.

Phase	Duration	Activity	Exit Condition
Candidate	Ongoing	Identified via audit_sources new GPU model detection, industry monitoring, or direct provider contact. Logged in shadow source tracking table with discovery date and source of identification.	*Meets all eligibility criteria above*
Shadow	30–60 days	Bronze collection notebook deployed. Data collected in parallel but excluded from Silver and Gold. API reliability, data quality, pricing pattern, and schema consistency assessed against existing sources.	*All quality checks pass; Oversight Committee approves integration*
Integration	1–7 days	Silver filter logic updated. source_id added to EXPECTED_SILVER_SOURCES in layer_reconciliation and SOURCE_EXPECTED in gold_spot_rates. audit_sources known-set updated. Methodology §6 updated.	*First Gold run includes new source; source_coverage flag reflects updated expected count*

Monitoring	30 days post-integration	New source treated as elevated-monitoring for 30 days. Any API schema change, unexpected price pattern, or collection failure triggers immediate review.	*No anomalies detected; source enters standard monitoring cadence*

4.1 Integration Code Changes

Source integration requires coordinated updates across five locations:

- Bronze collection notebook — new source-specific notebook in CCIR/Bronze/
- Silver filter cell — new source filter block and union leg in silver_spot_rates
- Gold source coverage — SOURCE_EXPECTED dict updated with expected source counts per (gpu_model, price_type_canonical)
- layer_reconciliation — EXPECTED_SILVER_SOURCES and BRONZE_SPOT_TABLES updated
- Methodology document — §6 source list updated; version bump per Change Management Policy

5. Ongoing Monitoring and Review Cadence

Source quality is monitored continuously through automated controls and periodic manual review. The monitoring cadence below defines what is checked at each frequency and who is responsible for review.

Cadence	Trigger	Activity	Owner
Daily	audit_sources API health check (06:00 CT Sunday; nightly in evening pipeline)	Authentication check, required field verification, schema diff vs. stored baseline, new GPU model detection. Any WARN logged to audit/audit_log.	Automated — audit_sources notebook
Weekly	audit_sources Sunday 07:00 CT full run	Source-specific structural checks (RunPod markup ratio, CoreWeave page size, TensorDock tier distribution, Nebius page size). Review WARN items from prior week.	Engineering — review audit log Monday morning
Monthly	First Monday of each month	Review audit_sources WARN history. Assess any new GPU model candidates identified during month. Review source_coverage REDUCED flags in delivery_manifest. Evaluate any provider pricing structure changes.	Engineering
Semi-annual	January and July	Oversight Committee reviews active source universe. Approves any pending shadow-period candidates for integration. Reviews removed source candidates. Changes published in advance per Change Management Policy.	Oversight Committee

Annual	Full methodology review	Complete source universe review including weighting, representativeness, and coverage gaps. Review against updated GPU market structure. Assess whether new model generations require new source onboarding.	Oversight Committee + Engineering

6. Source Coverage and Publication Hold Standards

CCIR publishes indices under degraded source coverage rather than suspending publication, except where coverage falls below the minimum thresholds defined below. This approach reflects the IOSCO P9 principle that a confidence flag degrades disclosure rather than suppresses publication. The source_coverage field in the published CSV provides explicit disclosure of the coverage state on each publication date.

Source Condition	Source Coverage	Action	source_coverage Flag
All expected sources contributing	**FULL**	Publish normally	*FULL*
1 source dark or sold out; remaining sources meet minimum obs floor	**REDUCED**	Publish with REDUCED flag. Log WARN in audit/audit_log. No Oversight Committee notification required unless condition persists > 3 days.	*REDUCED*
2+ sources dark simultaneously; total obs count >= 50% of 30-day average	**REDUCED**	Publish with REDUCED flag. Notify Oversight Committee within 24 hours. Document in governance log.	*REDUCED*
Source count < 2 for any published model	**MINIMAL**	Publish with MINIMAL flag. Notify Oversight Committee immediately. Escalate if condition persists > 24 hours.	*MINIMAL*
Total obs count < 50% of 30-day average AND source count < 2	**—**	Hold publication. Notify Oversight Committee. Resume only after Oversight Committee approval or condition resolves.	*Publication suspended*

The publication hold threshold — source count < 2 AND observations < 50% of 30-day average — is the condition under which the index lacks sufficient data to represent the market. A single-source rate with thin observations is not a market rate; it is a single provider's posted price. Publication under those conditions would misrepresent the index as a market signal.

7. Source Removal

A source may be removed from the active universe under the following conditions:

- API becomes inaccessible for more than 30 consecutive days with no resolution timeline communicated by the provider

- Provider ceases to offer NVIDIA datacenter GPUs at the tier required for CRI eligibility
- Provider's pricing methodology changes such that its prices are no longer comparable to other sources (e.g., transition to opaque bundled pricing without per-GPU decomposition)
- Provider enters a CCIR-affiliated relationship (equity, revenue share, or data licensing arrangement) that creates a structural conflict
- Oversight Committee determines that the source no longer satisfies eligibility criteria

Source removal follows the change classification tiers in the Change Management Policy. Removal of a source that materially affects a published index (defined as a source contributing to source_coverage FULL status for any model) is a Parameter Change requiring Oversight Committee approval and 30 days advance notice to index users. Emergency removal (e.g., data integrity concern) follows the Emergency tier with post-hoc disclosure within 5 days.

When a source is removed, SOURCE_EXPECTED in gold_spot_rates is updated to reflect the new expected count. Existing historical rows are not restated — source_coverage on prior dates reflects the coverage state at the time of publication, which is the correct audit record.

8. Relationship to Other Governance Documents

This policy is part of the CCIR governance framework and should be read alongside:

- CCIR_Methodology_v1_0_0.docx — defines Silver filter logic and source-specific deduplication rules (§§2.2–2.8)
- CCIR_Governance_v1_0_0.docx — IOSCO alignment statement including Principle 14 Not Applicable designation
- CCIR_Change_Management_Policy_v1_0_0.docx — change classification tiers governing source additions and removals
- CCIR_Current_State_March2026.docx — operational status including shadow source tracking table (build queue)